4-Week Home Child Care Program Plan

Based on **How Does Learning Happen? – Ontario's Pedagogy for the Early Years**

This simple program plan is designed for home child care providers working with mixed-age children. Activities are easy, low-prep, and use items you already have at home.

Inspired by guidance from the Ontario Ministry of Education's *How Does Learning Happen?* framework, focusing on:

- **Belonging** – Feeling safe and included
- **Well-Being** – Healthy bodies and emotions
- **Engagement** – Curiosity and play
- **Expression** – Communication and creativity

WEEK 1 – Getting to Know Each Other (Belonging)

Interest: **Friends & Family**

Day	Easy Activity	What Children Learn (HDLH Connection)
Monday	Show-and-Tell: children bring or talk about favourite toy	Belonging – children feel valued
Tuesday	Draw family with crayons	Expression – sharing their world
Wednesday	Group snack prep (wash fruit together)	Well-Being – hygiene + teamwork
Thursday	Name song (sing each child's name)	Belonging + Language
Friday	Free play with dolls/figures	Engagement – pretend play

Special Event Idea: Family photo wall

Provider Tip: Ask open questions like "Who is in your home?" or "What makes you happy?"

WEEK 2 – Exploring Our Senses (Engagement)

Interest: **Touch, Taste, Smell, Sound, Sight**

Day	Easy Activity	What Children Learn
Monday	Sensory bin with rice or pasta	Engagement – exploring textures
Tuesday	Taste test: sweet vs salty snack	Language – describing words
Wednesday	Nature walk sounds	Well-Being – outdoor calm
Thursday	Smell jars (vanilla, orange peel)	Curiosity + memory
Friday	Colour hunt around house	Cognitive – sorting & noticing

Special Event Idea: Bubble day outside

Provider Tip: Let children lead play – follow their interests.

WEEK 3 – Moving Our Bodies (Well-Being)

Interest: **Healthy Bodies**

Day	Easy Activity	What Children Learn
Monday	Obstacle course with pillows	Gross motor skills
Tuesday	Dance party with scarves	Expression + joy
Wednesday	Yoga stretch time	Self-regulation
Thursday	Ball rolling & catching	Coordination
Friday	Wash dolls & toys	Caring habits

Special Event Idea: Picnic lunch outside

Provider Tip: Praise effort, not perfection.

WEEK 4 – Creativity & Imagination (Expression)

Interest: **Art Everywhere**

Day	Easy Activity	What Children Learn
Monday	Paint with sponges	Creativity
Tuesday	Build with boxes	Problem solving
Wednesday	Story time + act it out	Language + confidence
Thursday	Sticker collage	Fine motor
Friday	Music parade with homemade instruments	Expression + teamwork

Special Event Idea: Mini art show for parents

Provider Tip: Ask children to explain their artwork.

Daily Routine Reminder (Simple Structure)

Morning: Free play + circle
Snack
Activity
Outdoor play
Lunch
Nap/Quiet time
Afternoon play + story
Pick-up

Materials List (Low Cost)

- Paper, crayons, glue
- Rice/pasta for sensory bins
- Recycled boxes
- Balls, scarves
- Books
- Nature items

Notes Section

Write observations about children’s interests here. Plan next week based on what they enjoyed.

Example: "Sam loved building towers → add more blocks next week."
